

IMD World Competitiveness Ranking and National Economic Success

Aarsh Modi

International Financial Management

Edward Strafaci

Which countries are the most competitive in the global economy? Which are the least competitive? How do countries at the bottom move up to the middle ranking?

Institutions Over Inertia in the IMD World Competitiveness Ranking and National Economic Success

National economic competitiveness not only reflects aggregate output, but it also captures the extent to which a country's institutions, including government policy, infrastructure, and regulated business environment, facilitate the sustainable creation of value. As per the World Economic Forum, "the set of institutions, policies and factors that determine the level of productivity of a country" (World Economic Forum, 2017). In this context, productivity can be viewed as "the ratio of what is produced to what is required to produce it" (Frankel & Kendrick, 2026). Amongst the 70 nations considered for analysis, Singapore, Hong Kong SAR, and Switzerland top the charts in terms of their competitiveness (IMD World Competitiveness Center, 2026a; Richter, 2024; Business Frontier, 2026). Currently, Venezuela, Namibia, and Mongolia are at the bottom of the list, suggesting they are the least competitive nations (IMD World Competitiveness Center, 2026a; Statbase, 2026).

The main differences between the most competitive and least competitive countries will be examined in this paper, as well as what the rise in Malaysia and Vietnam in recent times tells us about what makes a country competitive. I believe that competitiveness does not simply depend on productivity or resource abundance, but is increasingly a matter of the credibility and predictability of a nation's institutions (IMD World Competitiveness Center, 2026a). What lies behind this assertion is an assumption that foreign direct investment serves as a real-time signal of the credibility of institutions, going into countries where the regulation environment is predictable and leaving those where it is not. The investment thread runs through much of the paper, from the drop-off of Switzerland in 2026 to the capital flight from Venezuela to the recovering investment in Malaysia, since it provides one consistent measurement of institutional risk.

The essay is divided into six sections. In the first part, I will explain the framework used by IMD to measure competitiveness. The second section will be an analysis of the world's most competitive economies, focusing on similarities between them. The third section will discuss the structural

disadvantages that make economies such as Venezuela among the least competitive ones. In the fourth section, Malaysia and Vietnam will be used as examples of economies experiencing upward movement. In the fifth section, I will determine whether economies trapped in crises such as Venezuela can move up to become as competitive as Malaysia and Vietnam, and what needs to be done. Finally, in the sixth section, I bring these parts together into a broader explanation of what separates economies that rise in the ranking from those that do not.

Because many businesses and governmental organizations depend on the IMD ranking, an economy's rise or fall within the ranking could affect its cost of capital, its potential for foreign direct investment, and the confidence of its own domestic corporate sector. It is important to understand how some economies maintain a position near the top of the ranking while others stay at the bottom, and why some economies are able to switch from one end of the spectrum to the other.

Measuring Competitiveness Through the IMD Framework

Since 1989, the IMD World Competitiveness Center has assessed, every year, how countries provide an environment where their firms can compete and grow (IMD World Competitiveness Center, 2026b). The 2026 ranking used two different kinds of criteria to measure competitiveness, 92 criteria coming from an Executive Opinion Survey of business leaders and 172 “hard data” criteria taken from international, regional and national statistical data (The Southeast Asia Desk, 2026). Together, the number of these criteria came to approximately 264 criteria in four equal-weighted categories, economic performance, government efficiency, infrastructure and business efficiency (Singapore Economic Development Board, 2026; Voice of Vietnam, 2026). The use of more statistical data along with less data from an executive survey (The Southeast Asia Desk, 2026) indicates the fact that the IMD ranking methodology values more measurable and verifiable criteria while still taking into account how credible they look to the business leaders who work in them. Every category consists of five sub-factors of equal weight, and no statistic can determine an overall score of an economy.

Of all the objective measures contained in the economic performance factor, the flow of foreign direct investments is especially significant. While the growth of GDP and exports are backward-looking

data points, foreign investments reflect the expectations of an investor about the future stability of a country's institutions, which can be expected over several years' time. In the case of the sudden halt of direct investments seen in the year 2026 for Switzerland, this is more a signal regarding the stability of the institutions than an economic event.

The fact that should be noted here is that the approach does not depend on sheer production since a country may have high absolute values but may have a low position due to unpredictable institutions and cumbersome regulation. On the other hand, even the smallest and poorest in resources country like Singapore can get the first place due to high government and business efficiency regardless of its lower absolute values compared to larger economies (Business Frontier, 2026). As noted by Arturo Bris, the Director of the IMD World Competitiveness Center, in his 2026 report, many economies that occupy leading positions are neither the biggest, nor the richest, nor the richest in resources. These economies consistently obey the law (IDN Financials, 2026).

In today's era, the above-mentioned institutional approach has been deemed even more significant in 2026 because of the instability that prevails throughout the world in terms of geopolitics. According to the findings of IMD, in a situation where international systems and institutions do not work properly, firms find it essential to rely upon the sustainability and consistency of their own institutions within the country (IMD World Competitiveness Center, 2026a).

The Global Leaders, Singapore, Hong Kong, Switzerland, Taiwan, and the UAE

In the 2026 ranking, Singapore reclaimed its first-place ranking after finishing second in 2025, driven primarily by a seven-place jump in business efficiency to first place worldwide (Singapore Economic Development Board, 2026). Hong Kong SAR moved up to second place, maintaining its upward trend for three years now and being second in the world in terms of government efficiency, which was recognized by the IMD World Competitiveness Center as one of the competitive advantages of the territory (IMD World Competitiveness Center, 2026a). Switzerland, which held first place in 2025, slid two places down to third owing to its poor economic performance caused by weaker investment flows into the country, consistent with the trend mentioned above, in which weaker capital inflows tend to

accompany declining economic or institutional stability rather than occurring in isolation. This happened notwithstanding the fact that Switzerland remained the world leader in infrastructure and government efficiency, thus showing that institutional advantage alone will not compensate for poor economic performance of the country, since all four variables have equal weight in terms of the overall score (IMD World Competitiveness Center, 2026a). Taiwan managed to take fourth place, the best result in its history, owing to improved economic performance from tenth to fifth in the world, whereas the United Arab Emirates remained fifth after its impressive climb from seventh in 2024 (Business Frontier, 2026).

Table 1 and Figure 1 below depict the ten highest-ranking economies for 2026, ranked relative to Singapore's score of 100.0. It must be noted that the difference between the top three economies and the other seven economies in the top ten is very small, indicating that the world's most competitive economies are closely clustered together despite their very different sizes, populations, and resource endowments.

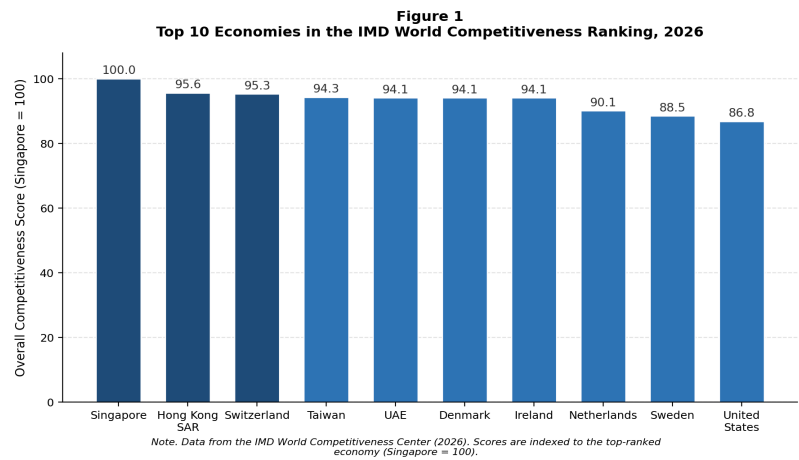
Table 1

Top 10 Economies in the IMD World Competitiveness Ranking, 2026

Rank	Economy	Overall Score	Year-over-Year Change
1	Singapore	100.0	+0.6
2	Hong Kong SAR	95.6	-3.6
3	Switzerland	95.3	-4.7
4	Taiwan (Chinese Taipei)	94.3	+0.6
5	United Arab Emirates	94.1	-2.0
6 (tie)	Denmark	94.1	-3.4
6 (tie)	Ireland	94.1	+2.8
8	Netherlands	90.1	+0.3
9	Sweden	88.5	-1.7

Rank	Economy	Overall Score	Year-over-Year Change
10	United States	86.8	+2.5

Note. Data from Business Frontier (2026) and Statbase (2026). Scores are indexed to the top-ranked economy (Singapore = 100).



However, even beyond the actual score, the qualitative factors that made each of the five leading economies occupy their place have shown that each leader attained its top rank through different strengths. The table below (Table 2) shows the competitive advantage that IMD identified for each of the five highest-ranking economies in 2026.

Table 2

Signature Competitive Strengths of the Top 5 Economies, 2026

Economy	Overall Rank	Signature Strength	Notable 2026 Development
Singapore	1	Business efficiency (ranked 1st)	Climbed seven places in business efficiency to reclaim the overall top spot
Hong Kong SAR	2	Government efficiency (ranked 2nd)	Third consecutive year of overall improvement

Economy	Overall Rank	Signature Strength	Notable 2026 Development
Switzerland	3	Infrastructure and government efficiency (both ranked 1st)	Overall rank fell two places after a sharp drop in economic performance
Taiwan	4	Economic performance (rose from 10th to 5th)	Highest overall ranking on record
United Arab Emirates	5	Sustained ascent since 2024 (from 7th to 5th)	Held its 2025 position amid a slowing regional pace of change

Note. Data from IMD World Competitiveness Center (2026a) and Singapore Economic Development Board (2026).

Although these economies differ in size and location, there are some traits common to the top five economies aside from their ranking values. For one, each economy has a very capable and flexible labor force, reasonably well-established government infrastructure, reasonably stable sociopolitical climate, and business environment where regulatory decision-making is predictable enough for companies to make long-term investments (Business Frontier, 2026). The economy of Singapore, for instance, benefits from high levels of participation of its citizens in the labor market as well as improvements in terms of productivity. On the other hand, the economy of Switzerland has capitalized on the trust that people have placed in its courts and regulatory framework for several decades despite fluctuations in economic performance (IMD World Competitiveness Center, 2026a).

The Structural Problems, Venezuela and the Bottom of the Ranking

If institutional credibility and reinforcing strengths are the key factors in determining the leaders on the 2026 ranking list, then their absence is the most probable reason for the laggards. With the lowest overall index of 22.4, which declined by 3.1 points in comparison with 2025, Venezuela was the lowest-ranked economy, Namibia (28.5) and Mongolia (39.0) were two other laggards (Statbase, 2026). The situation in Venezuela is explained by an ongoing economic crisis. In its report for 2026, the IMF

estimated Venezuela's inflation rate as 387.4%, by far the highest figure in the world, more than five times higher than the second-worst performing economy (Visual Capitalist, 2026). With a score of 10/100 in the Corruption Perceptions Index in 2025, Venezuela was one of the six worst performing territories in the world, along with South Sudan, Somalia, Yemen, Libya, and Eritrea (Transparency International, 2026). The complete lack of credibility is the factor that destroys competitiveness because bad governance deteriorates the same conditions of government efficiency and infrastructure development that made Singapore and Hong Kong leaders.

The link between institutional weakness and macroeconomic instability is not coincidental. The inflation problem in Venezuela, at least partly, is directly related to institutional weakness. When there is no independent monetary and regulatory institution that would control the fiscal behavior of the country and impose restrictions on it, the government has been financing the deficit by printing the money instead of collecting taxes, which is what the existence of rule-based and credible institutions is supposed to prevent. Thus, macroeconomic problems are not an independent factor of institutional failure but its direct result. Unstable currency and high levels of inflation, on the other hand, discourage foreign direct investments, which are key for maintaining good economic scores in economies where the institutions work properly.

These numbers highlight a trend that is seen throughout the bottom half of the 2026 rankings. The biggest yearly losses are made by economies which have been through a sharp economic, political, or financial shock. Romania suffered the biggest drop in the whole set of countries in the rankings, dropping 13.5 points to 43.1, while Puerto Rico dropped 9.9 points to 51.1 (Statbase, 2026). Table 3 shows the lowest-ranked and most declining economies of 2026.

Table 3

Lowest-Scoring and Steepest-Declining Economies, 2026

Economy	Overall Score	Year-over-Year Change	Note
Venezuela	22.4	-3.1	Lowest overall score in the 2026 ranking

Economy	Overall Score	Year-over-Year Change	Note
Namibia	28.5	-9.0	Second-lowest overall score
Mongolia	39.0	-1.9	Third-lowest overall score
Romania	43.1	-13.5	Largest single-year decline of any economy assessed
Puerto Rico	51.1	-9.9	Second-largest single-year decline

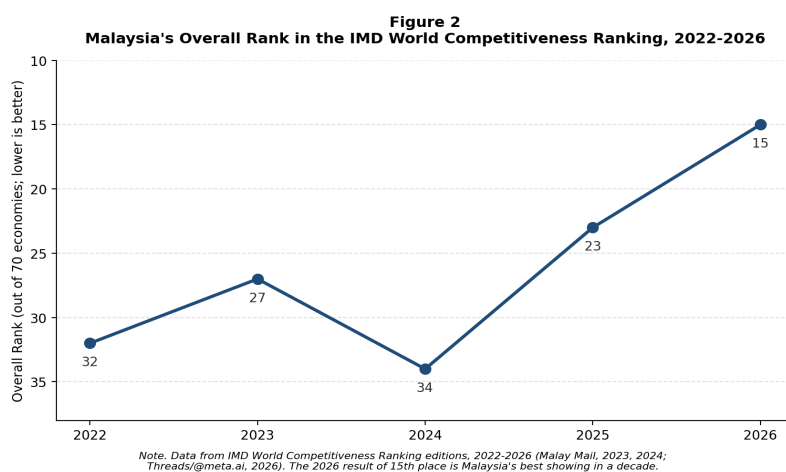
Note. Data from Statbase (2026).

The case of Venezuela demonstrates the same institution-based trend as those seen at the bottom half of the rankings in which poor institutions and regulation are consistently linked to economic instability. According to Statbase (2026), institutional weaknesses are one of the major problems that economies ranked at the bottom, including Brazil and Mexico, face. In the case of Venezuela, the country's exposure to commodity price fluctuations and limited access to international markets because of its heavy dependence on a single economic relationship (oil) is an additional factor that makes it particularly vulnerable. The absence of institutional diversification and robust industries leaves such countries open to currency depreciation, inflation, and capital outflows that are apparent in the Venezuelan economic situation. This example explains why the 2026 IMD report stressed the importance of institutional credibility rather than natural resource endowment in terms of competitive ability. An economy endowed with natural resources but with weak institutions is vulnerable despite the richness of its resource endowment.

Climbing the Ranks in Malaysia and Vietnam

From the highest performer to the lowest performer in the league table, both Malaysia and Vietnam exemplify the speed at which an economy's competitiveness is positively affected when currency stability measures, free trade policies, and infrastructure development are combined with better regulatory certainty and government efficiency in the delivery of governance services. Malaysia jumped eight spots to rank 15th out of 70 economies in 2026 from 23rd in 2025, its best result in a decade and making it

closer to achieving its target of becoming one of the twelve most competitive countries in the world by 2030 (Human Resources Online, 2026). This marked the end of a five-year rollercoaster journey. In 2022, Malaysia was placed at number 32, it moved to number 27 in 2023 due to positive economic growth and increased investor confidence, but moved backwards to 34 in 2024 because of poor economic performance due to a weak ringgit, after which it staged a steady recovery to rank 23 in 2025 and 15 in 2026 (Malay Mail, 2023, 2024; Human Resources Online, 2026).



This specific fall of Malaysia for the year 2024 is associated by Malaysian officials with currency depreciation and one-year lag in the ranking methodology, but the recovery from this fall is associated by Malaysian officials with the stabilization of ringgit currency, improved performance in international trade, and further foreign direct investment (Malaysian Reserve, 2024). The same recovery pattern has been reflected in investments flows. With the stabilization of ringgit currency, the foreign direct investment has served as the first signal of market confidence, just like in the case of Switzerland and Venezuela.

Vietnam is another complementing case because Vietnam first made it to the IMD rankings in 2026 at the 27th position among 70 economies, lagging only by one spot from Thailand (Nation Thailand, 2026; Voice of Vietnam, 2026). Vietnam has excelled in two categories, economic performance and business efficiency, where it was placed 19th worldwide due to its exports growing by 17% to reach USD 475.04 billion in 2025 and having a positive balance of trade of USD 20.03 billion in the same year (Voice of Vietnam, 2026; The Southeast Asia Desk, 2026). Taking into consideration the investment

model presented above, Vietnam's trade surplus and export growth can be explained by stable trade and regulatory policies that continue to lure manufacturing investments despite underdeveloped institutions.

Table 4 presents a summary of Vietnam's first appearance performance on various sub-factors.

Table 4

Vietnam's Debut Performance in the IMD World Competitiveness Ranking, 2026

Sub-Factor	Vietnam's Rank (out of 70)
Overall ranking	27th
Economic performance	19th
Business efficiency	19th
Domestic economy	16th
International trade	6th
Employment	11th

Note. Data from Voice of Vietnam (2026) and The Southeast Asia Desk (2026).

Even with this solid debut, however, IMD pointed out certain structural challenges which reflect the same structural problems seen in the region's infrastructure problem. With its poor infrastructure ranking at number 46, Vietnam was still lagging behind the rest of five economies in Southeast Asia, and even continued to suffer from difficulties in terms of labor productivity, technology capacity, and energy infrastructure owing to increasing demands for manufacturing production (The Southeast Asia Desk, 2026). Overall, both Malaysia and Vietnam seem to indicate that economies placed in the middle have the best chances of boosting competitiveness through economic stabilization and development of infrastructure.

What Would It Take for Venezuela to Climb From Crisis to Middle Tier?

For "middle tier," the benchmark can be taken from halfway between the economies, which is the 35th position in this list of 70 economies, as half the economies will be above that level and the other half

will be below that level. Romania, which has a score of 43.1, and Puerto Rico, which has a score of 51.1, represent the economy just above Venezuela. Both these economies have been recorded as registering some of the most steep decreases in their scores during the 2026 edition of the report, but both these economies are not as badly off as Venezuela is (Statbase, 2026).

The move down to 34th position for Malaysia was the result of one small depreciation of its currency, which occurred against the backdrop of existing institutions and infrastructure systems working well. The government efficiency and infrastructure indices remained intact despite a weakening economic performance index (Malaysian Reserve, 2024). Since the existing institutions did not deteriorate, it was enough for Malaysia to restore currency stability in order to reclaim its 19 positions within two ranking cycles. It is precisely this pattern that can be seen in Figure 2. A debut rank of 27th position for Vietnam is another example of the same pattern working in the opposite direction. The middle-level institutional base in combination with good trade performance resulted in a high-ranking index, despite weak infrastructure in Vietnam (The Southeast Asia Desk, 2026).

Venezuela's situation is fundamentally different in its nature. The country's score of 22.4 is not caused by one underperforming sub-factor that lies on a sound institutional foundation. It rather reflects a breakdown of multiple pillars of the economy, namely currency stability, rule of law, and public administration, that reinforce each other within the vicious circle. A strategy of correction of one macroeconomic variable without damaging the institutional basis, as it may happen in case of Malaysia, is simply out of reach for an economy like Venezuela's, since there is nothing left to be recovered to. A movement up in the ranking will definitely imply a stepwise process of reforms, starting with drastic monetary reforms capable of bringing the high level of inflation down to at least the level of other countries in the ranking. Then a slow rebuilding of the rule-of-law credibility may follow, which is reflected in the Corruption Perception Index score putting Venezuela among the six lowest-ranked territories of the world (Transparency International, 2026).

Table 5

A Two-Phase Reform Pathway for Bottom-Tier Recovery

Phase	Focus	Approximate Timeline	Comparable Signal
1	Currency and monetary stabilization	1–2 ranking cycles	Malaysia's 2025–2026 ringgit-driven recovery, though Venezuela would start from hyperinflation rather than moderate depreciation
2	Rule-of-law and anti-corruption reform	3–5+ ranking cycles	Consistent with IMD's finding that institutional credibility accumulates gradually (IMD World Competitiveness Center, 2026a)
3	Renewed FDI and trade diversification	Follows Phases 1–2, not concurrent	Vietnam's trade-driven debut at 27th, achieved only atop an already-functioning institutional base

Note. Timeline estimates derived from the pacing of Malaysia's currency-driven recovery (Malaysian Reserve, 2024) and IMD's characterization of institutional reform as a multi-cycle process (IMD World Competitiveness Center, 2026a).

This two-stage process is clearly spelled out in Table 5. In an optimistic reform scenario, the maximum Venezuela is likely to achieve in the short run is not the middle level where Malaysia and Vietnam currently stand, but the next level up from its present lowest-level cluster, along with other countries like Romania and Puerto Rico which experienced sharp drops in one year due to limited shock effects, not cumulative ones across several years (Statbase, 2026). To reach Malaysia's or Vietnam's level will take much more time, as it involves rebuilding institutional credibility, which neither economy has ever lacked.

Comparative Synthesis on What Separates the Top from the Bottom

This contrast can be seen most effectively when one considers how this gap depends on institutional stability and predictability. Table 6 presents a comparison of two top-ranking countries, Singapore and Switzerland, versus Venezuela which ranks last in the 2026 edition, using various institutional and macroeconomic criteria.

Table 6*Comparative Institutional and Macroeconomic Indicators, Top vs. Bottom Performers*

Indicator	Singapore	Switzerland	Venezuela
IMD Overall Score (2026)	100.0 (1st)	95.3 (3rd)	22.4 (lowest)
Corruption Perceptions Index (2025)	84	80	10
Projected 2026 Inflation Rate	Low and stable	Low and stable	387.4% (world's highest)

Note. Data from Statbase (2026), Transparency International (2026), and Visual Capitalist (2026).

The relationship shown in Table 6 is consistent with the qualitative case study evidence provided earlier. Countries that are ranked high in 2026 have both high levels of institutional credibility as determined by corruption perceptions and low, predictable levels of inflation, while Venezuela is ranked at the bottom because of the compounded effect of poor institutional performance and economic instability, representing a difference of almost 78 points from the highest-scoring country and being well behind all other countries evaluated in the report, even those that were identified above as the biggest decliners for a year. It is this particular relationship, rather than any single indicator, which seems to define competitiveness according to the 2026 IMD World Competitiveness Center report in the highly fragmented world (IMD World Competitiveness Center, 2026a). This issue of order of actions posed above is consistent with the data in the table. All aspects of Venezuela's poor performance compared to that of Singapore and Switzerland are interrelated, rather than isolated, and this is exactly why it will not be possible to make any progress on just one aspect.

Patterns Across the Ranking that Distinguish Economies That Climb

From the evidence examined in this paper, certain trends have emerged in relation to those economies that improved their competitiveness in 2026, especially those ranked in the middle of the list. In each of the case studies considered, it is evident that those economies having the best scores were always those identified by IMD as the most determined to uphold institutions and the rule of law, not necessarily the biggest or richest economies (IMD World Competitiveness Center, 2026a).

Moreover, the Malaysian example shows that the stability of the currency and economy is indeed a prerequisite in practice for the credibility of institutions to even appear in the ranking. The fact that the institutions of the country have been more or less preserved did not prevent the Malaysian currency devaluation in 2024 from pushing Malaysia down seven positions on the list (Malaysian Reserve, 2024).

Similar to trade openness and diversification of exports, infrastructure development and investments have a relationship with upward progress especially when accompanied by effective customs management and regulations, as can be noted from the sixth position occupied by Vietnam in terms of international trade despite its first appearance on the list at the 27th place (Voice of Vietnam, 2026). In terms of infrastructure development, it has been observed that every country evaluated in 2026 was weak in the area of infrastructure in comparison with its performance in other areas, which means that even good governance requires further investments in infrastructure (The Southeast Asia Desk, 2026).

Finally, the evidence points to the importance of sequencing at least on par with that of the content itself. The Malaysian experience points to the fact that currency stabilization and macroeconomic stabilization seem to be quickest ways to see ranking gains, as they directly influence the economic performance category, while other institutional changes like lowering corruption levels or building the rule of law take time to gain credibility (Malaysian Reserve, 2024; IMD World Competitiveness Center, 2026a). Seen in light of the Venezuelan example, it means that economies trying to move up the ranking list under conditions of a macroeconomic crisis have a completely different task than those economies trying to recover from a localized shock on a healthy institutional foundation.

Conclusion

Indeed, the 2026 IMD World Competitiveness Ranking only confirms a growing trend that is evident from previous rankings, national competitiveness has ceased to depend on country size, wealth, or resource endowments, and now relies on the credibility of institutions, government efficiency, and macroeconomic stability (IMD World Competitiveness Center, 2026a). Singapore, Hong Kong SAR, and Switzerland hold positions at the top of the ranking not due to being among the most powerful and wealthiest countries in the world but as a result of having developed a unique formula based on efficient

governance, sound infrastructure, and flexible business environment. The way foreign direct investments have been flowing to them through the years indicates that their institutions are deemed credible enough by global capital to make a long-term commitment. Venezuela holds the worst position in the ranking for the same reasons, inefficient institutions, unstable currency, and high inflation rate form a vicious circle that makes an investment channel impossible while countries at the top manage to keep it open. However, it is the case of Malaysia that reached its best ranking in a decade and that of Vietnam that demonstrated a good result in its debut in the ranking that prove that an economy may achieve significant progress in a short period of time provided that its institutions are still functioning while only its macroeconomic parameters need to be corrected. On the other hand, for an economy similar to Venezuela's, such process is impossible as long as currency and institutional collapses should be addressed simultaneously in a particular order.

Work Cited

Business Frontier. (2026, July). *Top 20 most competitive economies in the world in 2026*.

<https://thebusinessfrontier.com/top-20-most-competitive-economies-in-the-world-in-2026/>

Frankel, M., & Kendrick, J. W. (2026, July 25). *Productivity*. Encyclopedia Britannica.

<https://www.britannica.com/money/productivity>

Human Resources Online. (2026, June 22). *World Competitiveness Ranking 2026: How did APAC economies perform?*

<https://www.humanresourcesonline.net/world-competitiveness-ranking-2026-how-did-apac-economies-perform>

IDN Financials. (2026, June 26). *Indonesia's competitiveness ranking falls below Malaysia and Vietnam*.

<https://www.idnfinancials.com/news/65240/indonesias-competitiveness-ranking-falls-below-malaysia-and-vietnam>

IMD World Competitiveness Center. (2026a, June 18). *Strong institutions are economies' greatest buffer against economic shocks, IMD World Competitiveness Ranking finds*. IMD.

<https://www.imd.org/news/strong-institutions-are-economies-greatest-buffer-against-economic-shocks-imd-world-competitiveness-ranking-finds/>

IMD World Competitiveness Center. (2026b). *2026 World Competitiveness Ranking*.

<https://www.imd.org/centers/wcc/world-competitiveness-center/rankings/world-competitiveness-ranking/>

Malay Mail. (2023, June 22). *Economists: Improvement in IMD World Competitiveness Ranking reflects investors' confidence in Malaysia*.

<https://www.malaymail.com/news/money/2023/06/22/economists-improvement-in-imd-world-competitiveness-ranking-reflects-investors-confidence-in-malaysia/75702>

Malay Mail. (2024, June 21). *Tengku Zafrul: Last year's weak ringgit main reason for Malaysia's slide in World Competitiveness*.

<https://www.malaymail.com/news/malaysia/2024/06/21/tengku-zafrul-last-years-weak-ringgit-ma>

in-reason-for-malaysias-slide-in-world-competitiveness-but-ranking-to-improve-as-currency-stronger-now/140783

Malaysian Reserve. (2024, July 8). *Concerns mount over Malaysia's IMD World Competitiveness Ranking decline.*

<https://themalaysianreserve.com/2024/07/08/concerns-mount-over-malaysias-imd-world-competitiveness-ranking-decline/>

Nation Thailand. (2026, June 18). *Thailand rises to 26th in IMD competitiveness ranking, but Vietnam closes gap.* <https://www.nationthailand.com/business/economy/40067591>

Richter, F. (2024, June 18). *Chart: The world's most competitive economies.* Statista.

<https://www.statista.com/chart/30233/global-competitiveness-world-map/>

Singapore Economic Development Board. (2026). *Singapore reclaims top spot in IMD world competitiveness ranking as business efficiency improves.*

<https://www.edb.gov.sg/en/business-insights/insights/singapore-reclaims-top-spot-in-imd-world-competitiveness-ranking-as-business-efficiency-improves.html>

Statbase. (2026). *World competitiveness ranking: Data by countries from 1997 to 2026.*

<https://statbase.org/datasets/indexes-and-ratings/world-competitiveness-ranking/>

The Southeast Asia Desk. (2026, July). *IMD World Competitiveness Ranking 2026: Southeast Asia winners & losers.*

<https://www.thesoutheastasiadesk.com/p/imd-world-competitiveness-ranking-2026-southeast-asia>

Transparency International. (2026, February 10). *Corruption Perceptions Index 2025: Decline in leadership undermining global fight against corruption.*

<https://www.transparency.org/en/press/corruption-perceptions-index-2025-decline-leadership-undermining-global-fight>

Visual Capitalist. (2026, June 9). *Ranked: The world's inflation extremes in 2026.*

<https://www.visualcapitalist.com/ranked-worlds-inflation-extremes-in-2026/>

Voice of Vietnam. (2026, June 28). *Vietnam joins world's top 30 most competitive economies, eyes further reforms.*

<https://english.vov.vn/en/economy/vietnam-joins-worlds-top-30-most-competitive-economies-eyes-further-reforms-post1310320.vov>

World Economic Forum. (2017, September). *What exactly is economic competitiveness?*

<https://www.weforum.org/stories/2017/09/what-is-economic-competitiveness/>